

Meridian Post-mortem Review - 2024 H2

Themes across incidents

Fourteen incidents were logged in H2 (see: Incident log 2024). Three themes dominate. First, retry amplification: INC-2408 (partner retry storm) and INC-2412 (webhook retry amplification) share a root pattern - downstream slowness converted into upstream load. Retry budgets are now mandatory at every client boundary.

Second, lifecycle hygiene: the wildcard certificate expiry (INC-2413) and the vault token expiry (INC-2405) were both silent-countdown failures. Everything with an expiry date now needs a monitored lead-time alert, owned by a team, not a person.

Third, configuration blast radius: the edge-proxy reload drop (INC-2410) and the search-indexer env-var crashloop (INC-2411) were both single-change events with no canary. The deploy pipeline's canary gate now covers config-only changes too.

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Numbers and follow-through

Median time-to-detect fell from 9 minutes (H1) to 4 minutes after the alert-threshold tuning in September; see the Alert history 2024 dataset for the full series. Median time-to-resolve held at 47 minutes; the long tail is dominated by incidents requiring a partner or vendor on the call (INC-2407, INC-2412).

Action-item completion: 31 of 38 items closed within 30 days. The seven stragglers are tracked in the quarterly review; three concern the audit_log partitioning, which finally landed in December (see: Capacity and costs 2024, note on the December storage row).

The on-call load stayed within policy: no engineer served more than one primary week per month (see: On-call rotation 2025 H1 for the upcoming schedule).